Setting a Management Foundation

✳ *Know yourself first. Then get to know the people you lead.*

NAME _____ DATE _____

01 Reflect
On your strengths and growth areas.

02 Choose
Your preferences, one pair at a time.

03 Name
What helps you and what gets in your way.

04 Compare
Share with a team member. Then act on it.

1 Personal Assessment

Strengths
Name 3–5, personal or professional.

STRENGTH	HOW IT HELPS ME AS A MANAGER

Growth Areas
Name 3–5 weaknesses, blind spots or opportunities to improve.

GROWTH AREA	HOW IT CAN GET IN MY WAY AS A MANAGER

2 How I Communicate, Process & Stay Motivated

✳ **Check one box in each pair.** Neither option will fit perfectly. Choose the one that's true for you more often than not. There are no right answers, only useful differences.

Communication

01	*I'd describe my communication style as…*	☐ **Direct** — I say what I mean, plainly.	☐ **Diplomatic** — I choose my words with care.
02	*When I deliver critical feedback, I focus first on…*	☐ **Clarity** — making the message clear and honest.	☐ **Care** — how the message will land with them.
03	*When I collaborate, I prefer to work…*	☐ **Live** — in person or on a video call.	☐ **In writing** — email, Teams or a shared doc.
04	*As a communicator, I tend to share…*	☐ **The essentials** — the headline, details if asked.	☐ **The full picture** — context, background and detail.
05	*Conflict or disagreement tends to…*	☐ **Drain me** — I need to step back before I engage.	☐ **Energize me** — I'd rather get it out in the open.
06	*I find out how my message landed…*	☐ **In the moment** — I read the room as I go.	☐ **Afterward** — I ask or follow up to check.

2 How I Communicate, Process & Stay Motivated

✳ *Continued. One box per pair, true more often than not.*

Feedback

07	*I prefer to receive critical feedback…*	☐ **In writing first** — so I can gather my thoughts.	☐ **In the moment** — in a direct conversation.
08	*Praise means the most to me when it's…*	☐ **Private** — one-on-one or in a direct message.	☐ **Public** — in a meeting or in front of the team.
09	*I want feedback on my work…*	☐ **Often** — in small doses, as things happen.	☐ **Saved up** — for regular, scheduled check-ins.

Information

10	*When I get a lot of information on a topic, I feel…*	☐ **Overloaded** — give me the key points.	☐ **Equipped** — the more context, the better.
11	*A lack of hyper-clear direction makes me…*	☐ **Uneasy** — I want clarity before I move.	☐ **Energized** — I like figuring it out as I go.
12	*Information sticks best when it's…*	☐ **Written or visual** — I need to see it.	☐ **Spoken** — I need to talk it through.
13	*When I'm asked to weigh in on something new, I prefer to…*	☐ **Think out loud** — discuss it on the spot.	☐ **Think it over** — and respond once I've processed it.

2 How I Communicate, Process & Stay Motivated

✳ *Continued. One box per pair, true more often than not.*

Motivation

14	*I'm most motivated by…*	☐ **Recognition** — people I respect seeing my work.	☐ **Tangible rewards** — pay, title and advancement.
15	*I do my best work with…*	☐ **Latitude** — freedom to decide how it gets done.	☐ **Structure** — clear steps and established process.
16	*When I'm handed a new assignment, I want…*	☐ **The why** — the goal; I'll figure out the how.	☐ **The how** — a clear plan and what good looks like.

A Quick Pulse

Right now, most days… **1** rarely → **5** almost always

I get to do what I do best.	1	2	3	4	5
I have the autonomy I need to do my work well.	1	2	3	4	5
I can see how my values connect to my work.	1	2	3	4	5

3 What Helps & What Hinders

Think about the managers you've done your best and worst work for. What did the great ones do that helped you perform (direct feedback, goals over tasks, weekly check-ins)? What did others do that got in your way (micromanaging, going quiet, shifting priorities)?

A great manager helps me by…

01

02

03

04

05

An ineffective manager hinders me by…

01

02

03

04

05

The Short Version

✳ *Look back over your answers. Distill them.*

If someone only knew three things about working with me, they'd be:

1

2

3